

44 Adding emphasis

You can add emphasis, or even a sense of drama, to a statement through grammar and pronunciation. Inversion is one effective way to do this.

⚙️ **New language** Inversion after adverbials

Aa **Vocabulary** Media and celebrity

🧩 **New skill** Adding emphasis to statements

44.1 KEY LANGUAGE INVERSION AFTER NEGATIVE ADVERBIALS

In more formal or literary texts, inversion (when the normal order of words is reversed) is used for emphasis after negative adverbial phrases like "not only," "not since," and "only when."



In this simple sentence, the subject comes before the verb.

She is a famous singer. She is also a very good actor.

Not only is she a famous singer, **but she's also** a very good actor.

After the negative adverbial, the subject and the verb swap places.



44.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES INVERSION AFTER NEGATIVE ADVERBIALS

Negative adverbials are generally followed by auxiliary verb + subject.

Not since I was a teenager **have I** enjoyed a performance so much.

Not until the performance was over **did he** look up at the audience.

Where there is no auxiliary verb, "do" is used.



Only if it stops raining **will the race** go ahead this afternoon.

Only when he emerged from the car **did the fans** start cheering.

Only after the race **did he** realize what he had achieved.



Little do they know how lucky they are to be successful.

Little did they realize how difficult fame would be.

